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seven-tenths of a second behind. Norris felt that if the race had been a lap longer, he could have tried a move on Verstappen.

Though Red Bull prevailed, McLaren's ability to give the championship leader a run for its money for the second event in a row portends positive signs for the championship's competitiveness.

As McLaren celebrated another positive weekend, missing a win by a whisker, the battle for second is also slowly heating up. For now, Ferrari has a healthy lead over McLaren (187 vs. 124), but the latter has turned up the heat on the Italian giant over the last two weekends. Ferrari pinned hopes on the upgrades it brought to Imola to take the fight to Red Bull but underperformed in front of the adoring Tifosi. The Scuderia qualified behind the two McLarens and, in the race, struggled to give the British team any trouble as Leclerc trailed Norris. The other Ferrari of Sainz lost fourth place to Piastri at the pit stops.

While Leclerc gave something to

the fans by finishing third, there will be a lot of introspection back in Maranello. The good news was that the gap to Red Bull seemed to have come down, and fans will hope these two teams can keep the energy drinks giant honest in the coming races to breathe some excitement back into the sport.

Moto GP

Prima Pramac rider Jorge Martin broke clear of reigning champion Francesco Bagnaia with a double in the French GP at Le Mans. The Spaniard secured pole position and won the Sprint and Grand Prix to extend his championship lead to 38 points. But the big winner this weekend was Marc Marquez, who starred on both days following a disappointing qualifying in which he was only 13th fastest but managed to finish second in both events.

Martin cruised to victory in the Sprint race after factory Ducati rider Bagnaia got a poor start and fell down the order on the opening lap. The Italian eventually retired from

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the race, gifting 15 points to his title rival.

On Sunday, Bagnaia made amends to snatch the lead from pole-sitter Martin at the start and keep his position for two-thirds of the race. Martin made an overtake eight laps before the chequered flag, but the two-time champion reclaimed it within a few corners. On the next lap, Martin decisively got the job done on the Ducati rider to seal his second win of the season. Meanwhile, Marquez charged from 13th place and caught up to the top two in the closing stages of the lap. On the last lap, the seven-time champion made an opportunistic move on Bagnaia to pinch his second place of the weekend.